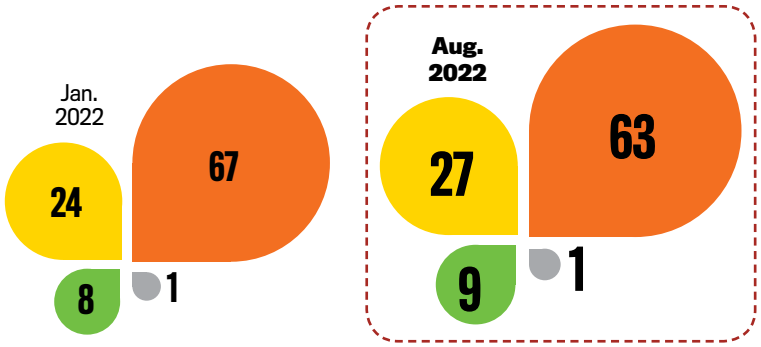
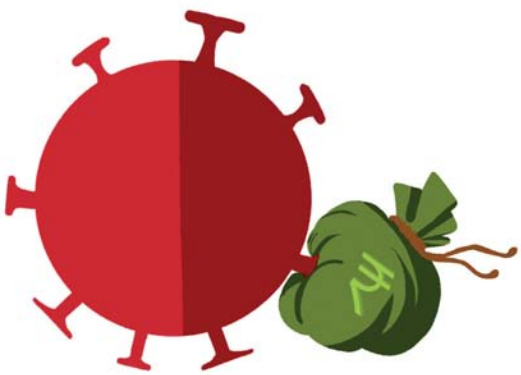
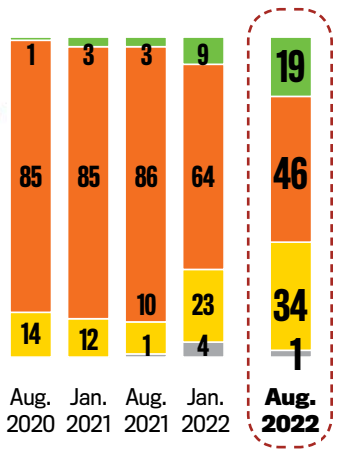
Q. How do your current daily expenses compare with last year?



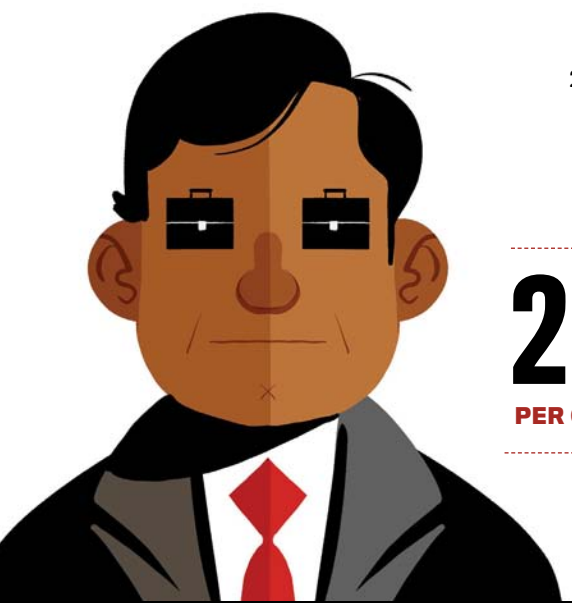
Have gone up but still manageable · Have become difficult to manage
Have come down · Others/ DK/ CS

Q. HOW HAS COVID-19 AFFECTED YOUR ECONOMIC STATUS?





Income has gone up · It has gone down
No change · DK/ CS



29 PER CENT | **RESPONDENTS, THE HIGHEST SINCE FEB. 2016, RATE THE CENTRE'S HANDLING OF THE ECONOMY AS POOR OR VERY POOR**

DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say
(All figures in percentage)

ing the quarter ending June 2020, which coincided with the pandemic's first wave. Similarly, 13 million jobs were lost during the second wave in the June 2021 quarter. Then came the third wave, which forced many businesses to continue with curtailed operations, though the impact of the virus was not as severe as in the earlier two waves. The unemployment rate in India eased to 7.12 per cent in May from 7.83 per cent in April 2022. However, the labour participation rate—the proportion of people in employment or seeking work among the working population—hardly improved in May compared to April.

Only robust economic growth can create more jobs. GDP growth was just 4.1 per cent for the fourth quarter of 2021-22, the slowest in the past four quarters. The CMIE's latest numbers show that employment in July grew only 6.3 million, compared to a fall of 13 million in June. The big fall in employment was in rural India. About 147.5 million were employed in agriculture in July 2022 against 163.8 million in July 2021. In the MOTN survey, 56.4 per cent of the respondents said that the unemployment situation in the country today is 'very serious', and another 17.1 per cent felt that it was 'somewhat serious'. In all, 73 per cent of respondents thought that the unemployment situation was serious. This compares with 71 per cent who thought so in January.

Meanwhile, those who felt that their income has gone down due to the pandemic have seen a steady decline, reflecting the partial recovery in jobs. From a high of 86 per cent in August 2021, those who felt their income went down had fallen to 64.1 per cent in January this year, and to a further 45.54 per cent in the latest MOTN survey. The share of those who said that their income has risen is at 18.53 per cent in the latest survey, compared to 8.5 per cent and 3 per cent, respectively, in the